

Unified Payments Interface (UPI) Guide

Introduction

Unified Payments Interface (UPI) is an instant real-time payment system developed by the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI). It allows users to transfer money directly between bank accounts using mobile devices.

Key Features

- Instant money transfer
- 24×7 availability
- Interoperability across banks
- Mobile-first payment experience
- Secure authentication using UPI PIN

What is a UPI ID?

A UPI ID, also called a Virtual Payment Address (VPA), is a unique identifier used to send and receive money.

Examples: user@oksbi, user@paytm, user@ybl

How to Register for UPI

1. Install a UPI-enabled application.
2. Verify your mobile number.
3. Select your bank account.
4. Create a UPI PIN.
5. Start making transactions.

How to Send Money

1. Open your UPI application.
2. Select "Send Money".
3. Enter UPI ID or scan QR code.
4. Enter amount.
5. Confirm using UPI PIN.

How to Receive Money

1. Share your UPI ID.
2. Generate a payment request.
3. Receive funds instantly.

Transaction Limits

Banks may set daily transaction limits. Most UPI applications support transactions up to ₹1 lakh per day, subject to bank policies.

Security Best Practices

- Never share UPI PIN.
- Never share OTP.
- Verify recipient details before payment.
- Avoid unknown payment requests.
- Use trusted applications only.

Common Frauds

Collect Request Scam: Fraudsters send payment requests claiming rewards or refunds.

QR Code Scam: Scanning a QR code generally sends money, not receives money.

Fake Customer Support: Fraudsters impersonate bank representatives and request sensitive information.

Frequently Asked Questions

Q: Is UPI free?

A: Most person-to-person transactions are free.

Q: Can UPI work without a bank account?

A: No.

Q: Can I have multiple UPI IDs?

A: Yes.

Q: What should I do if money is debited but not received?

A: Contact your bank and raise a dispute.